

Pranav Tripathi

Berkeley, CA | pranav_trip@berkeley.edu | linkedin.com/in/pranav-trip | (425) 623-0711

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley | **Mechanical Engineering** | **Regents' & Chancellor's Scholar** May 2028
4.0 GPA | Relevant Courses: M51-54 (Calculus, Linear Algebra), P7A (Mechanics), E7 (Python/Matlab)

EXPERIENCE

Frostbyte Technologies | *Co-Founder* June 2024 – Present

- Leading a startup team to develop an autonomous robot to clear ice from sidewalks and improve pedestrian safety
- Awarded \$12,000 by Samsung, and partnered with Gates Foundation to make device policy-compliant for public use
- Fabricated passive snow funnel and salt tank (400+ sq. ft. coverage), with FEA and TopOpt for 28% weight reduction
- Coordinated with software team to integrate control modules such as a gyro, GPS, and camera on a Raspberry Pi 5

D&Y Nexus Labs | *Mechanical Engineering Consultant* August 2026 – Present

- Consulting on the design of a methane flux detection module that eliminates the need for manual gas sampling
- Reinforcing module for outdoor use, with IP54 water resistance through custom urethane gaskets and band clamps
- Assisting with an ESP32-based IoT cloud server to process methane flux and enable live remote monitoring

Engineering Solutions @ Berkeley | *Technical Member* August 2026 – September 2026

- Created a water filter with no electronics, 14+ L/min throughput, 0.2-micron filtering, for use in remote areas
- Conducted physics-based calculations and modelling for internal fluids systems (ball-valve pump, two-stage filter, and filter backwash system), and a torsion spring system for 5+ mins of automatic operation in emergency situations

Computer Science Council | *President* June 2023 – June 2026

- Led 40+ member team to organize over a dozen free computer science competitions and workshops for local students
- Taught 1,800+ students from 16 local schools, covering concepts such as Python, Machine Learning, and AI Ethics
- Managed three sub-teams for workshop/competition development, event logistics, and advertising campaigns

RESEARCH

Embodied Dexterity Group & General Motors | *Undergraduate Design Lead* August 2025 – Present

- Collaborating on QUAD, a robotic hand with 11 DoF and visuotactile sensing, under PhD Ben Davis and GM
- Applying kinematic principles to design novel QDD linkages in the thumb and index fingers for high dexterity, and an asymmetric linkage between the middle and ring fingers for greater rigidity and non-uniform grasping
- Improved DFM and DFA through 2D machined internals and optimized tolerance stacks with lower fabrication costs

Boston University Robotics Lab | *Mechanical Engineering Intern* June 2025 – August 2025

- Created autonomous navigation algorithms using solely visual input from a camera under Prof. Roberto Tron
- Developed simulations of the optical flow (movement) of points along path boundaries using Numpy and Matplotlib
- Programmed an OpenCV optical flow algorithm that calculates offset from a path using inverse kinematics, and ROS2 feedback nodes with PID control for course-correction, resulting in <18% deviation from path centerlines

Lake Washington Tech Math Dept. | *Assistant Researcher* December 2025 – May 2026

- Optimized popular search algorithms to enable pathfinding via minimal computations under Prof. Choudhury
- Simulated shortest-path algorithms Dijkstra's and A* in Python using data structures such as queues and linked lists
- Created a novel algorithm, "Convergent Bidirectional A*" which performs 93% faster than Dijkstra's and 52% more than A*, by running A* from both ends of a search and actively prioritizing paths that bring the two ends closer

SKILLS

Mechanical: 3D Design (SolidWorks, OnShape, Fusion360), Kinematics, FEA, Validation, GD&T, DFM/DFA

Electronics: Programming (Python, Java, C++, MATLAB), Github, Circuitry and Sensor Integration (Fritzing)

Robotics: ROS2, Computer Vision (Optical Flow, Projections), Controls (PID, Odometry), Signal Filtering